

## BM 3 – Lesson 2: Abigail

### Wisdom on the Move



**Theme:** Faith & Foresight



**Background Text:** 1 Sam 25:2–39; Prov 15:1



**Key Verse:** Proverbs 15:1

“A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.”



*Wisdom in motion: faith that chooses peace over pride.*



### Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Sam 25:18–20

<sup>18</sup> Then Abigail hurried and took two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five seahs<sup>[a]</sup> of parched grain, one hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys. <sup>19</sup> She said to her young men, “Go on before me. Behold, I am coming after you.” But she didn’t tell her husband, Nabal. <sup>20</sup> As she rode on her donkey, and came down hidden by the mountain, behold, David and his men came down toward her, and she met them.

David was angry because Nabal had insulted him and refused to help. Recognizing how foul her husband behaved, Abigail stepped in quickly to bring food, humility, and peace before things got violent.

Abigail wasted no time. She quickly gathered two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five prepared sheep, roasted grain, clusters of raisins, and cakes of figs. She packed them on donkeys and said to her servants, “Go on ahead. I will follow you shortly.” But she didn’t tell her husband Nabal what she was doing. Sometimes moving strategically is moving stealthily!



#### Reflection Question

**When was the last time you acted on faith to prevent harm or conflict?**

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## Main Course

### Bite 1 – Nabal’s Foolishness, 1 Sam 25:10–11, 14,17

<sup>10</sup> Nabal answered David’s servants and said, “Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants who break away from their masters these days. <sup>11</sup> Shall I then take my bread, my water, and my meat that I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men who I don’t know where they come from?”

<sup>14</sup> But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal’s wife, saying, “Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to greet our master; and he insulted them. <sup>17</sup> Now therefore know and consider what you will do; for evil is determined against our master and against all his house, for he is such a worthless fellow that one can’t speak to him.”

Later, one of Nabal’s servants told Abigail how David’s men had been good to them in the fields, how they had not been harmed or stolen from, and yet Nabal “rushed on them” with insults. He warned her that disaster was hanging over the household because Nabal was such a worthless man “that one can’t speak to him”

#### CST

Nabal’s arrogance created a crisis. Foolish pride will always test someone’s faith. Abigail’s faith met that test with wisdom, not words of war. The bible says in James 1:19-20 (KJV, paraphrased), that we should be ‘quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to wrath. Because the wrath of man doesn’t produce the righteousness of God. Nabal wasn’t trying to hear anyone of reason and sometimes we hear through emotional filters, and it is important for us to identify and call out these barriers to the truth, just like Nabal’s servants did to Abigail.

#### Reflection Question

Have you ever had to respond to someone’s anger or disrespect with peace instead of pride?

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### Bite 2 – Put the Blame on Me, 1 Sam 25:23-24, 28

<sup>23</sup> When Abigail saw David, she hurried and got off her donkey, and fell before David on her face and bowed herself to the ground. <sup>24</sup> She fell at his feet and said, “On me, my lord, on me be the blame! Please let your servant speak in your ears. Hear the words of your servant.

<sup>28</sup> Please forgive the trespass of your servant. For Yahweh will certainly make my lord a sure house, because my lord fights Yahweh’s battles. Evil will not be found in you all your days.

She strategically pointed David back to God’s promise over his life—that Yahweh would surely make him ruler over Israel. She urged him not to carry needless bloodshed or vengeance on his record when that day

came. Abigail took on the blame for her husband's offense—an act of courage and foresight. She spoke life into David's calling instead of fueling his wrath. Her humility redirected the entire situation.

"Standing in the gap isn't about being a doormat; it's about being a shock absorber. It means you care more about God's honor and keeping people safe than about winning a petty argument. An 'Abigail move' can literally save a life—I know because it happened to me.

### Reflection Questions

- What does it mean to “stand in the gap” for someone else's mistake?

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- Have you ever had to de-escalate a situation you didn't cause?

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- Did your response bring God honor or dishonor?

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### Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Sam 25:32–35

<sup>32</sup> David said to Abigail, “Blessed is Yahweh, the God of Israel, who sent you today to meet me! <sup>33</sup> Blessed is your discretion, and blessed are you, who have kept me today from blood guiltiness, and from avenging myself with my own hand.

<sup>35</sup> So David received from her hand that which she had brought him. Then he said to her, “Go up in peace to your house. Behold, I have listened to your voice and have granted your request.”

David calmed down. The fight stopped before it ever started. Abigail's actions saved her household and kept David from making a choice he'd regret. Hallelujah, praise the Lord he listened to reason.

One act of wisdom can save an entire household. Faith foresaw danger; wisdom found peace. Abigail's actions honored God, David, and her own integrity.

## Reflection Question

What would the world look like if more of us prayed for wisdom before reacting?

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## Dessert – When God Handles It, 1 Sam 25:38–39

<sup>38</sup> About ten days later, Yahweh struck Nabal, so that he died. <sup>39</sup> When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Blessed is Yahweh, who has pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from evil. Yahweh has returned the evildoing of Nabal on his own head.”

About ten days later, the Lord struck Nabal, and he died. When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Praise the Lord, who has avenged the insult I received from Nabal and has kept me from doing it myself.” Then David sent messengers to propose marriage to Abigail.

When God vindicates, He also elevates. Abigail’s humility brought her favor—she went from the wife of a fool to the bride of a future king.

## To-Go Box

- Faith and foresight are more than belief—they are wisdom in motion.
- Pride creates unnecessary battles; humility opens unexpected doors.
- When we humble ourselves and act with discernment, God can turn conflict into protection and even promotion.

## Closing Prayer (Abigail – Wisdom on the Move)

“Lord, thank You for Abigail’s example of wisdom and courage. Help me respond with grace when other people’s foolishness creates messes around me. Teach me to honor You, treat Your people well, and trust You to handle what I can’t. In Jesus’ name, amen.



## Personal Prayer Space

Write your own reflection or prayer to God about trusting His Word and His authority in your life:

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## Word Study

- **Abigail (Hebrew: אֲבִיגַיִל – “Avigayil”)** — “My father’s joy” or “source of joy.” Her character embodied the beauty of her name; she became a channel of peace and joy even in chaos.
- **Nabal (Hebrew: נָבָל – “Nabal”)** — “Foolish” or “senseless.” His actions reflected his name, showing how arrogance blinds us to wisdom and leads to destruction.
- **Scapegoat (Hebrew: עֶזְאָזֵל – “Azazel”)** — From Leviticus 16, referring to the goat released into the wilderness carrying the sins of the people. Symbolically, Abigail bore the “guilt” of her household to intercede for peace.
- **Foresight** — Spiritual sensitivity that anticipates and prepares for what God is revealing ahead of time.

Write one line about where you need *foresight* right now:



## Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with \_\_\_\_\_ and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal’s pride led to his \_\_\_\_\_.
3. David praised God for Abigail’s \_\_\_\_\_.
4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented \_\_\_\_\_ and brought peace.

(Check answers in the Appendix)

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# Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (AE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition

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## Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

### Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.  
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
  2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.  
➤ True
  3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.  
➤ True
  4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else.  
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
  5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.  
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.
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## Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with **wisdom** and faith, not fear.
  2. Nabal’s pride led to his **death**.
  3. David praised God for Abigail’s **good sense/wisdom**.
  4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented **bloodshed/killing** and brought peace.
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## Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a distance.
  2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great faith."
  3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the Word.
  4. The centurion understood the power of authority.
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## Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process

Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the correct result:

- 1 Joseph's request for Jesus' body → **Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor.**
- 2 Building his own tomb → **God used a personal plan for divine purpose.**
- 3 Wrapping Jesus in linen → **The burial fulfilled prophecy with reverence.**
- 4 Rolling the stone → **A temporary seal that set up resurrection power.**